

Bob Ingram

'As I Was Saying ...

Two For the Road

FOR THE SECOND TIME, an El Paso team is likely to celebrate winning the Texas League pennant on the road.

In 1962, the Sun Kings clinched the Texas League title when they were in Amarillo. They opened the champagne when the team was traveling back to El Paso on the bus.

The league was not divided into divisions then. There was a Shaughnessy Playoff. The Sun Kings lost in that series but it was not played to determine the championship, which already had been decided.

In El Paso's second Texas League title in 1968, the Sun Kings were fortunate to win the title at home. They took the title against Arkansas, the East champions, at Dudley Field. Chuck Tanner's team had a wild celebration in the clubhouse after the clinching.

The Sun Dodgers will win or lose the 1972 championship on the road. Winners of the first two games of the title series with Alexandria, they should do a victory dance and champagne pouring in Alexandria.

Stan After Bigger Job

THE CLUB WILL break up in Alexandria. So, El Paso fans had their last glimpse of the season of most of the players last night.

Stan Wasiak, the manager, will go directly to his home in Mobile, Ala.

In one episode of a chain of interesting events here this summer, Monty Basgall resigned and Wasiak replaced him. The patient Polack did a very fine job.

His return to El Paso next year is problematical.

Ambition stirs in the breast of Wasiak. "I'd like to get up to the majors," he said. He could be hired as a coach on a big league team and there have been cases where big league clubs have reached down into the minors and hired managers who were unknown in the bigs.

Wasiak is a strong candidate for manager of the year in the Texas League. In fact, right now he stands out above any manager with the possible exception of Duke Snider at Alexandria. "It would help me to gain that honor," Stan said.

Deep, Deep Farm System

THE FIRST TWO games of the playoff in El Paso were attended by Buzzie Bavasi, general manager of the San Diego Padres, who operate the Alexandria team, president Bobby Bragan of the Texas League and Bill Schwepe, farm director of the Los Angeles Dodgers.

Bavasi must not have been overjoyed at what happened at Dudley Field in the first two games. But he's bound to be pleased with the development of some Alexandria players who will be of almost immediate help to the hard-pressed Padres in San Diego.

The depth of the Dodger farm system is a tribute to Schwepe. Every club in the Dodger system from Albuquerque in the Pacific to Daytona Beach in the Florida State is or has been in title playoffs this year.

The remarkable thing about the El Paso club was the fact that the Sun Dodgers could give up such pitching aces as Jeff Zahn and Rick Rhoden in Albuquerque and lose Lee Lacy to the big club and still win the Western Division title in the league.

"It looks like Bakersfield in the California had to pay the price," Schwepe said. Bakersfield won the first half title in the league. Then several of its players were sent to El Paso. The Bakersfield club didn't repeat in the second half and lost in the playoff.

Bakersfield's loss was El Paso's gain. And El Paso fans gained a lot by having the Dodgers here this season.

Sun Bums Look Like Cinch



GOOD STARTER—Wayne Burney gave the Sun Dodgers a good start in the 10-3 victory over the Alexandria Aces in the first inning last night. "I hit a high fast ball," he said. Burney has been one of the Sun Dodger hitting heroes of the series. Burney is being congratulated by Stan Wasiak as the player rounds third on his way home after hitting the homer. (Herald-Post Photo by Bill Thompson)

U.S. Wins 2 Olypmic Races

By MIKE RABUN
MUNICH (UPI) — Vice Matthews of New York led a 1-2 U.S. sweep in the finals of the men's 400-meter run and Rod Milburn of Oklahoma, L.A., equalled the world record in winning the 100-meter hurdles in the Olympic Games.

Matthews and teammate Wayne Collett of Santa Monica, Calif., took the gold and silver in the 400 meters after John Smith of Los Angeles, the third U.S. finalist, pulled up lame with an injured leg. Matthews was timed in 44.7 seconds.

Matthews and Collett then stood together on the No. 1 podium during the medals ceremony and chatted, pointedly ignoring the playing of the U.S. national anthem even though third-place Julius Sang of Kenya stood at attention.

The crowd of more than 80,000 boomed this exhibition, and the two Americans gestured back with upraised clenched fist, the "black power" salute as they left the stadium with the crowd still booing.

Rod Milburn of Southern University tied the world record of 13.2 seconds in the 110-meter hurdles. Fast-closing Guy Druet of France took the silver medal in 13.3 and Tom Hill of Jonesboro, Ark., won the bronze medal in 13.5.

Big 7th, Need Only One More

The Sun Dodgers today were as close to the Texas League pennant as a team would be to a world series title after winning the first three games in the big league seasonal wind-up.

After winning the first two games of the championship series against Alexandria, the Sun Dodgers are so close to a title that Jimmy the Greek would take such a thing off the boards.

After the Sun Dodgers beat Alexandria 10-3 last night at Dudley Field, Stan Wasiak was hopeful of ending the series in Alexandria tonight. He will start Bernie Beckman against the Aces.

"WE HAVE a big edge in the series," he said. "We need only one victory. We'll be playing loose. All the pressure will be on Alexandria. The Aces are in a position where they can't make a single mistake. We could lose a game or two at Alexandria and still be in good shape. I'd say that if we can't take one of the three games there we don't deserve to be champions."

The Sun Dodgers by their play last night looked like champions. They've not been known as a big-inning team this year but they had one last night, scoring six runs on nine hits in the seventh inning.

LEE ROBINSON, who started it off with a single, had two hits in the inning as the Sun Dodgers more than battled around. Six of the Sun Dodgers had two hits during the night.

It could be clearly established as definitely a team game. But if they were standouts they had to be Dennis James who pitched six innings of shutout ball, Dave Allen who finished up strong in relief, Wayne Burney who has been a hitting star in the series and started the Sun Dodgers off with a homer in the first inning last night and Joe Danilek.

THE LAS CRUCES youth made the big play of the



HAPPY ENDING—As Dave Allen came off the mound after disposing of the last Alexandria batter in last night's game at Dudley Field, a crowd of happy Sun Dodgers surrounded him. Andy Cohen, the Sun Dodger coach, Stan Wasiak, the Sun Dodger manager (center), straight victories in their Texas League championship series with the Alexandria Aces. (Herald-Post Photo by Bill Thompson)

game. It was a running catch of John Grubb's liner in the seventh inning. The Aces had two men on base. They would have scored had Daniels not made the catch. He took the ball after a hard run.

"I almost didn't get to it," he said. "I barely caught it in the web of my glove."

James pitched very well until he hurt his shoulder falling down in an effort to field Willie Wilson's bunt in the sixth. Shaken up, he gave up homers to Grubb and Ivie to enable Alexandria to tie the score at 3-3.

THE SUN DODGERS united it in the bottom of the sixth with a double by Terry McDermott and a two-base blow by Steve Patchin. The victim was Dan Spillner. He wasn't around to see the roof fall in on his team in the seventh. Robinson started it off with his pinch-hit single. He was thrown out trying to

stretch it to a double. Then the cloudburst came. Before the inning was over, the Aces were a badly beaten team and the Sun Dodgers were jubilantly marching toward a pennant.

They need only one more win for the title. Allen is the player with the mustache near the far right of the photo. At his left is Andy Cohen, the Sun Dodger coach, Stan Wasiak, the Sun Dodger manager (center), straight victories in their Texas League championship series with the Alexandria Aces. (Herald-Post Photo by Bill Thompson)

ALEXANDRIA 10-3 Sun Dodgers
Landon, 2b 5 0 0 Daniels, cf 1 1 1
Wilson, 3b 5 1 0 Burney, rf 1b 5 2 0
Grubb, 1b 4 0 1 Spencer, 2b 4 2 0
McDermott, 2b 4 0 3 McDermott, 1b 4 1 2
Ivie, 1b 4 0 1 Ivie, 1b 4 0 0
Patchin, 2b 4 0 1 Patchin, 2b 4 0 0
Hill, 1b 4 0 1 Hill, 1b 4 0 0
Spillner, 2b 4 0 1 Spillner, 2b 4 0 0
Allen, 1b 4 0 1 Allen, 1b 4 0 0
James, 1b 4 0 1 James, 1b 4 0 0
Daniels, 1b 4 0 1 Daniels, 1b 4 0 0

Totals 39 3 9 3 Totals 37 10 14 9
ALEXANDRIA 10-3 Sun Dodgers
El Paso 129 800 000-3
B — Hodges, Royster, Plesner, Allen.
LOB — Alexander, K, El Paso 7, 28.
McDermott, Patchin, Burney, Landon, HR.
— Burney, Grubb, Ivie, SB — Royster, 5.
Plesner.
IP H R ER BS SO
Spillner, 4 5 1 0 1 2
James, 3 3 2 0 1
Hodges, 2 2 0 0 1
Allen, 2 2 0 0 0
W — Spillner, U — Gaspner, Harris.
Cannon — 2 in A — 1234.

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Sept. 7, 1972 Page C-5

Athletics Get Vet Catcher

CHICAGO (UPI) — Veteran catcher Larry Haney has been reacquired by the Oakland Athletics in a straight cash deal.